PILOT · OUTTURN EDITION

NHS OUTLOOK

What was published, compared with the pre-release outlook

3 of 8 indicators improved on their previous result; 2 worsened. 6 performed better than forecast, and 7 remained inside their expected range. The weakest results against forecast were A&E four-hour and Urgent community response.

12 November 2026
8 indicators

Release months differ by measure; each row is dated.

3	**improved** 2 worsened	**6**	**beat forecast** 2 missed	**7**	**inside range** 1 outside

Forecast is the estimate published before the release. **Target outlook** is updated with the new results; its chance change is against the pre-release forecast. Green/red indicates whether actual performance was better/worse than forecast.

INDICATOR	PREVIOUS	FORECAST	ACTUAL	TARGET OUTLOOK updated 12 Nov 2026
URGENT CARE				
A&E four-hour performance → 95% constitutional standard	74.4% Sep 2026	74.9% Oct 2026 80% range 73.0%–76.7%	74.0% Oct 2026 Broadly unchanged 0.9 pp worse than forecast Within expected range	Mar 2027 76.8% <1% chance of meeting goal Little change since forecast Goal ≥82.0%
Category 2 ambulance response → 18-minute standard	31.3 min Sep 2026	33.7 min Oct 2026 80% range 27.9 min–38.9 min	32.8 min Oct 2026 Worsened 1.4 min 1.0 min better than forecast Within expected range	Mar 2027 24.6 min 52% chance of meeting goal Up 3pp since forecast Goal ≤25.0 min
PLANNED CARE				
RTT within 18 weeks → 92% constitutional standard	65.2% Aug 2026	65.1% Sep 2026 80% range 63.9%–66.3%	65.8% Sep 2026 Improved 0.6 pp 0.8 pp better than forecast Within expected range	Mar 2027 66.6% 6% chance of meeting goal Little change since forecast Goal ≥70.0%
Diagnostics waiting over six weeks → 1% operational standard	24.7% Aug 2026	23.7% Sep 2026 80% range 21.2%–25.6%	22.6% Sep 2026 Improved 2.1 pp 1.1 pp better than forecast Within expected range	Mar 2027 20.8% 7% chance of meeting goal Little change since forecast Goal ≤14.0%
Cancer treatment within 62 days → 85% constitutional standard	71.9% Aug 2026	69.7% Sep 2026 80% range 68.0%–71.1%	70.7% Sep 2026 Worsened 1.2 pp 0.9 pp better than forecast Within expected range	Mar 2027 74.2% 4% chance of meeting goal Little change since forecast Goal ≥80.0%
COMMUNITY				
Two-hour urgent community response → 70% national standard	85.5% Aug 2026	85.9% Sep 2026 80% range 85.2%–86.6%	85.4% Sep 2026 Broadly unchanged 0.4 pp worse than forecast Within expected range	Mar 2027 86.0% >99% chance of meeting goal Little change since forecast Goal ≥70.0%
Community waiting list within 18 weeks → 80% by March 2029	75.8% Aug 2026	74.9% Sep 2026 80% range 73.8%–75.9%	76.1% Sep 2026 Broadly unchanged 1.2 pp better than forecast Above expected range	Mar 2027 75.6% 15% chance of meeting goal Up 4pp since forecast Goal ≥78.0%
MENTAL HEALTH				
Talking Therapies within six weeks → 75% national standard	83.4% Aug 2026	84.1% Sep 2026 80% range 82.3%–85.6%	84.2% Sep 2026 Improved 0.8 pp 0.1 pp better than forecast Within expected range	Mar 2027 84.7% >99% chance of meeting goal Little change since forecast Goal ≥75.0%

How to read this. Outlooks are one-month-ahead forecasts made only with information available before release. The 80% range reflects historic forecast errors. The target-date column compares the projected value with the stated threshold for the indicated month. The chance is provisional and model-implied, estimated from the projected 80% range assuming a Normal distribution; it is not a validated probability of policy success or of sustaining the standard. Provider signals compare actual performance with a path fixed six months earlier; they are prompts for review, not rankings.

Sources. NHS England A&E attendances and emergency admissions · NHS England Ambulance Quality Indicators · NHS England referral to treatment waiting times · NHS England diagnostic waiting times and activity · NHS England cancer waiting times · NHS England two-hour urgent community response · NHS England community health services waiting lists · NHS Talking Therapies monthly statistics. Planning milestones and standards are cited in each indicator deep dive.